

AAR: FOSDEM & CHAOSScon EU 2026

Representative: Georg Link, Open Source Committee

Location: Brussels, Belgium

Executive Summary

Georg represented the Open Source Committee at **FOSDEM 2026** and **CHAOSScon EU 2026**. The focus was to bridge the gap between sustainable funding models and decentralized technology. OSC was established as a thought leader in the blockchain-sustainability niche including high-level dialogues with EU institutional funders and major ecosystem players.

Key Activity 1: FOSDEM Presentation

Title: *Securing the Next Grant: Early Insights on Aligning FOSS and Funders* **Format:** Live Session ([Recording Link](#))

- **Attendance:** ~100 participants.
- **Key Feedback:** Participants noted a scarcity of blockchain-focused content at FOSDEM, positioning our committee as a thought leader in this niche.
- **Q&A Focus:** Heavy engagement regarding the mechanics of the **Paid Open Source Model (POSM)**. The audience showed specific interest in the transition from traditional grants to a recurring paid contribution model.

Key Activity 2: CHAOSScon EU Panel Facilitation

Subject: Funding Open Source

Format: Interactive "Fishbowl" (Audience participation via rotating chairs)

I facilitated a high-impact panel featuring a diverse cross-section of the funding ecosystem:

- **German Sovereign Tech Agency & EU Sovereign Tech Fund advocates:** Discussing state-level support.
- **Commons Hub Brussels & Open Collective:** Discussing platform-based community funding.
- **Maintainer (AsyncAPI):** Providing the "boots-on-the-ground" perspective of maintainer burnout and financial needs.
- **Author of the report** "[Funding Europe's Open Digital Infrastructure: The Economic, Legal, and Political Feasibility of an EU Sovereign Tech Fund \(EU-STF\)](#)"

Outcome: The fishbowl format allowed for a dynamic exchange between institutional funders and the community, highlighting the urgent need for the exact types of structured models (like POSM) discussed at FOSDEM.

Strategic Outcomes & Networking

The trip successfully established bridges between the OSC and major institutional entities:

Contact	Key Discussion Point	Status
Ethereum Foundation	Deep dive into the Intersect treasury model and how POSM ensures sustainable funding for core devs.	Follow-up: Meeting held; OSO involved.
Sustainable ADA	Exchanged notes on long-term contributor health and financial longevity within the Cardano ecosystem.	Follow-up: Initial connection established.
Sovereign Tech Fund	Explored how state-level funding models align with decentralized treasury structures.	Follow-up: Ongoing.

Notable Successes

- **Cross-Ecosystem Learning:** High interest from Ethereum Foundation staff in our treasury mechanics suggests an opportunity for cross-chain governance standards.
- **OSO Integration:** Successfully transitioned networking leads to the **Open Source Office (OSO)** to explore future collaborations and formalize the connections made in Brussels.
- **Niche Authority:** Because FOSDEM 2026 had limited blockchain representation, we have a "thought-leader" advantage. We should continue to submit talks here to maintain this presence.